A world in perspective

Geography / Field notes

Geography connects places, people, and natural systems.

A map is a model of the world, not the world itself.

LATITUDE AND LONGITUDE

Latitude measures distance north or south of the equator.

Longitude measures distance east or west of the prime meridian.

Both are measured in degrees.

The equator is 0 degrees latitude.

The prime meridian is 0 degrees longitude.

Think about it: why do we need two coordinates to locate a place?

Reading the landscape

Geography / Connections

Landforms develop through processes acting over time.

Tectonic activity builds mountains and shapes ocean basins.

Weathering breaks down rock; erosion moves the fragments.

WATER SHAPES THE LAND

Rivers transport sediment from higher ground toward the sea.

Floodplains and deltas form where sediment is deposited.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. What is the difference between weathering and erosion?

2. What does latitude measure?

Answers: breakdown versus transport; distance north or south of the equator, measured in degrees.